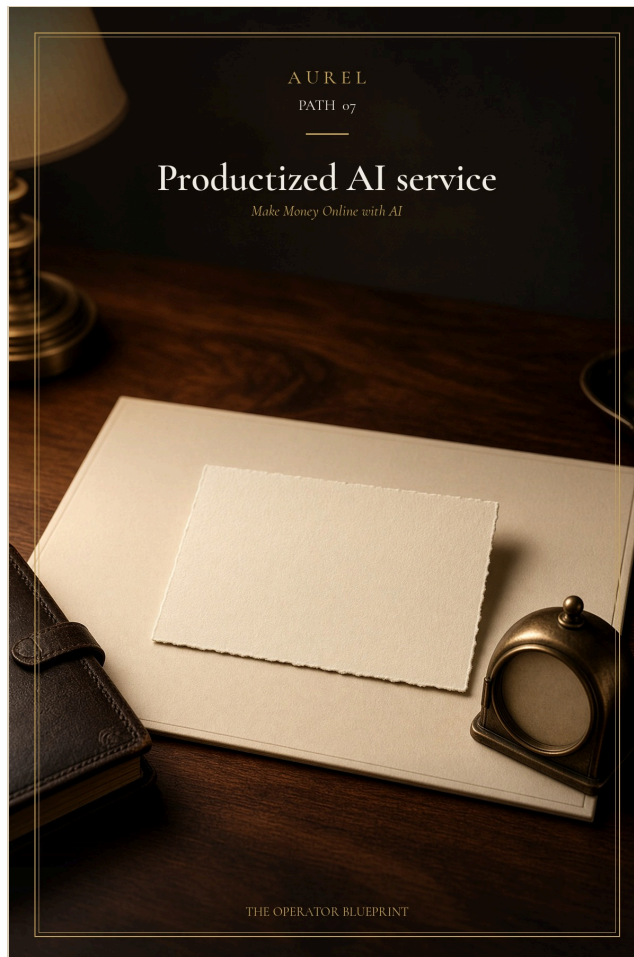




PATH 07

Productized AI service

Do not sell hours. Sell a named package with a date on it.

17 minute read · 3,672 words

Who this is for

You can get a result for someone else in a known number of days, using AI for draft and you for quality.

Time to first

3–14 days with outreach

Tools

First sale

One paid package with a written scope.

Cash window

\$300–\$1,500 first packages

Leave this alone

Calendly, Stripe invoice or deposit link, a one-page agreement.

A menu of 12 services. Unlimited revisions. Custom everything.

Why this prints cash faster than a file

A service is slower to scale and faster to cash. If you need money this month, this path beats a playbook. You will still take notes. Those notes become the file you sell later.

Do not sell hours. Sell a named package with a date on it. Hours train people to haggle your Tuesday. A package trains them to say yes or no.

What a package is The package has a name, a deliverable, a timeline, a price, and a definition of done. “I’ll help with your AI” is not a package. “12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600” is. You can hold the second one in your hand. You can put it on a calendar. You can take a deposit against it.

Where AI sits AI drafts. You edit. They never see the raw model output. Quality is your name, not the model’s. If they wanted the raw window, they would already have it. They are paying for a result that does not sound like a press release, delivered by a date.

What this is not It is not a retainer with vague “AI support.” It is not a menu of twelve services. It is not unlimited revisions. It is not custom everything. Those are how a \$600 job becomes a \$600 relationship that eats your month.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you can get a result for someone else in a known number of days, using AI for draft and you for quality. You need one job you have finished more than twice. You need the spine to take a deposit before you open a chat.

You are a fit if People already ask you to “just look at this.” You can name what “done” looks like without a two-hour discovery call. You can keep a 7-day or 14-day date. You are willing to write a one-page agreement that fits on a phone.

Skip this path if You freeze when someone asks what it costs. You want to be available for any AI problem. You cannot say no to a sixth round of “quick tweaks.” You have never shipped the result for yourself. Do not sell a week of posts if you have never posted a week.

If you only want to sell files and never talk to a buyer, use the playbook or template path. This path is faster cash because a human is in the loop. That human is you. Plan for that.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write this before you design a logo: “[Name of package]: [deliverable] in [days] for [price]. You get files, not a login to my brain. One revision window. Deposit holds the seat.”

Sam’s sentence is the model: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. You can swap the deliverable. You cannot swap the specificity. If you cannot fit the offer on one line, you have two packages. Split them, then pick one.

Who it is for, in the same breath Name the buyer next to the deliverable. “For a one-person shop that needs a week of posts and a page that matches, without living in a chat window.” If the buyer is “anyone using AI,” you will spend intake explaining what you do.

What is in, what is not In: the 12 posts, the one landing draft, one revision, a 15-minute walkthrough, files in a folder they own. Not in: a strategy offsite, a brand workshop, managing their accounts, a second landing page, unlimited voice notes. Write the “not in” list. Buyers relax when they see the walls.

What ‘done’ looks like

Done is one paid package with a written scope. Not a maybe. Not a “we’ll figure it out on a call.”
Money in, scope on a page, date on a calendar.

The job bar - Deliverable they can open without you (a folder they own)
- Timeline you kept, or you told them before the date slipped - One revision window, used or expired - A 15-minute walkthrough, not a second project hiding in a call - They never saw the raw model output

The business bar Deposit arrived before you started. The one-page agreement was sent. You asked for a referral while they were happy. You wrote the SOP so the second job is faster. If you skip the SOP, you sold a job. You did not build a path.

Price, deposit, and the first-seat discount

First packages live at \$300–\$1,500. Under \$300 you will attract people who want a miracle and a friend. Over \$1,500 on job one, you will invent a process during a job that is too expensive to fumble. Sam’s \$600 for a 7-day content-and-landing package sits in the honest middle: real money, finishable week.

How to pick the number Estimate the hours if you were slow, including edits. If it is ten hours and you cannot do it in a week, the package is too big. Cut the deliverable, not the sleep. Then pick a round number you can say out loud without coughing: \$600, \$800, \$1,200. Do not use \$597. You are not a storefront banner.

Deposit Take a deposit before you open a chat window. Half is clean. The rest on delivery, before the revision window if you like, or after the walkthrough. Stripe invoice or a deposit link. If they need to “just hop on a call first,” the call is the job. Charge for a paid consult or send the cheaper file instead.

The first-seat discount Offer one discounted first seat if you need a case, then never discount it again without a reason you can say out loud. “First seat, \$400, I can use the result as a named example” is a reason. “You seem nice” is not. After that seat, full price.

The first 72 hours

You do not need a portfolio site. You need one page, ten asks, and a way to take money.

Hours 1–6: write the package on one page Who it is for. What is in. What is not. Timeline. Price. What they must provide (voice notes, old posts, offer, deadline, three examples they like). How many revisions (one is enough). Deposit. Where the files will live. Put your name and a start date like “next Monday if the deposit is in by Friday.”

Hours 7–24: the rails Calendly for a 15-minute kickoff or walkthrough — not a free hour. Stripe invoice or deposit link. A one-page agreement that repeats the package page in slightly drier words. Test the payment link with a dollar if you need to know it works.

Hours 25–72: ten people who already trust you Send the package to ten people who already trust you. Not a cold list. People who have asked you for help, hired you adjacent, or complained about the exact job. One discounted first seat if you need a case. When they say yes, take the deposit before you open a chat window. Then intake. Then you start.

If nobody says yes in 72 hours, you still have a page. Keep asking. Three to fourteen days with outreach is the window, not three hours of hoping.

The path, step by step

Twelve steps. One package all the way through. If you have two, you have none.

Step 1. One package Name, deliverable, days, price. Write it so a tired person can forward it. If you add a second package this week, you will explain both and sell neither.

Step 2. Intake: problem, budget, ability to implement If they have no problem you can name, no budget for \$300–\$1,500, or no ability to post what you make, stop. Send them the cheaper file instead. A buyer who cannot implement will blame the posts.

Step 3. Deposit, then chat Invoice or deposit link first. Kickoff after. Working before the deposit is how “quick questions” become the whole job, unpaid.

Step 4. Kickoff form Assets, voice, deadline, examples they like, words they refuse, the offer the posts must serve. A form beats a 45-minute call that you have to transcribe.

Step 5. You run AI internally Draft in a tool they do not sit in. Edit until it sounds like them, not like a model. They never see the raw output. If a line is wrong, it is your line.

Step 6. Midpoint check, short A screenshot or three sample posts on day 3, not a new scope. If they want a different product, that is a different package after this one.

Step 7. Delivery in a folder they own Google Drive, Notion, a zip — they keep it if you disappear. No hostage login.

Step 8. A 15-minute walkthrough Show them where things live and what to post first. Then stop. The walkthrough is not a workshop.

Step 9. One revision window Written dates. “One round, 48 hours after delivery.” After that, a new package or a polite no.

Step 10. Ask for the referral while they are happy The day of the walkthrough, not a month later. One sentence. One ask.

Step 11. Write the SOP What you asked for, which prompts you used, where you edited, how long it actually took. The second job should be faster. If it is not, you did not write the SOP. You remembered vibes.

Step 12. Full price, no discount The first seat may have been cheaper. This one is not, unless you have a reason you can say out loud. Book the next seat before you invent package two.

Worked example: Sam's \$600 week

Sam writes for small service businesses on the side of a day job. People kept asking for “help with AI content.” That sentence made Sam tired. Sam named a package instead: 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days for \$600. Files in a folder. One revision. Deposit holds the seat.

The one-pager Who: a one-person shop that already knows what they sell and needs a week of posts plus a page that does not sound like a brochure. In: 12 posts (mix of short updates and two longer notes), one landing draft (headline, sections, FAQ, closing ask), one revision, 15-minute walkthrough. Not in: posting for them, a logo, a second offer, strategy calls. They must provide: offer, three examples they like, words they hate, any photos they already have, a deadline if a launch is real. Timeline: 7 days from deposit. Price: \$600. Deposit: \$300. Revision: one round, 48 hours after delivery.

The first seat Sam sent the page to ten people who had asked for help. One owner of a tutoring practice said yes at \$450 as the case-study seat, with permission to describe the result without student names. Deposit first. Kickoff form the same day. Sam drafted in a private chat, edited every post, and sent three samples on day 3. The owner changed one promise that was too strong.

Sam fixed the rest to match. Day 7: folder, walkthrough, invoice for the balance. One revision on two posts. Done.

After Sam wrote a two-page SOP: form questions, the prompt stack, the edit pass, the folder structure. Next job was \$600, no discount. A referral from the tutor paid for week three. Sam still takes notes for a playbook. The package prints cash this month. The file can wait.

Copy you can paste

Say the package. Then stop talking.

One-pager headline 12 posts and one landing draft in 7 days. You get files, not a login to my brain.

Ask (to ten people who already trust you) I have one seat this week for [package] at [price]. Deposit holds it. Here is what is in, what is not, and the date: [link]. If it is not useful, ignore this.

First-seat version I am taking one discounted first seat at [lower price] so I can use the result as a named example (you can say no to the name). Same scope, same week. After this, it is [full price].

After they say yes Sending the deposit link now. Kickoff form follows when it clears. I start on the date in the one-pager, not before.

Referral ask If someone you know needs [package] this month, send them the page. I have [one] seat left in [week]. I will treat them like I treated you.

What not to write “Let’s hop on a quick call and I’ll see how I can help.” That call becomes the job. “Unlimited revisions until you love it.” That is a hostage situation with extra steps.

Week-by-week

This is a 3–14 day path if you already know the job. Treat week one as a job, not a brand launch.

Day 1: package page Write the one-pager. Price, deposit, in/out, revision rule. Calendly, Stripe invoice or deposit link, one-page agreement. Test the link.

Days 2–4: ten asks Personal messages. One discounted first seat only if you truly need a case. Do not post a menu. Do not add a second package because the first ten were quiet.

Days 5–7: deliver the first job Deposit, form, draft internally, edit, midpoint sample, folder, 15-minute walkthrough, one revision window. They never see raw model output.

Week 2: SOP Write what you actually did. Time it. Cut anything that did not earn its minutes. Ask for the referral.

Week 3: full price, no discount Same package. Same days. Better SOP. If you want a second product, make it the playbook from the notes, not a second service that splits your calendar.

The quality bar

They should be able to use the files the day you hand them over, without you in the room after the walkthrough. That is the bar.

The raw-output test If you would be embarrassed to put your name under a paragraph, it does not ship. Models draft. You cut hype, check facts they gave you, and match their examples. A landing draft that could belong to any business is not done.

The date test 7 days means 7 days from deposit, not from the fifth follow-up email. If you cannot keep the date, the package is too big. Cut posts, not honesty.

The revision test One round. Written. If you need three rounds to make it good, your midpoint check is missing or you skipped the form. Do not buy peace with extra rounds. You will teach the next buyer that the wall is fake.

The folder test They own it. A login you control is not delivery. If the host dies, they still have the words.

What to count

Count jobs, not vibes.

Count these - Paid packages with written scope. First one is the milestone.
- Days from ask to deposit. If this is over two weeks, your page is vague or you are asking strangers. - Hours you actually spent versus the SOP. If job two is not faster, the SOP is a diary, not a process. - Revision use. If every job uses the round to change the offer, intake is broken. - Referrals asked vs referrals received. Asking once, on the happy day, is the whole system.

Ignore these for now A public “AI agency” identity.

Hour charts. A second service line. Testimonials you wrote for them. Count cash collected and dates kept.

A good first month is one or two \$600-class jobs delivered on time, not twelve half-sold conversations.

Objections you will hear

“Can we hop on a call first?” You can do a 15-minute Calendly after they have the one-pager, or you can send the cheaper file. A free hour is the job. Do not donate it.

“I need a custom thing.” Custom everything is on the leave-alone list. If their job is 80 percent your package, sell the package. If it is 20 percent, say no or quote a different dated package later — not this week.

“\$600 is a lot for something AI can do.” AI can draft. They are paying for 12 posts and a landing draft that match their offer, in 7 days, with your name on the quality. If they want the window, they already have it. Stay kind. Do not argue economics. Point at the date and the files.

“Can you just do hours?” No. Hours have no done. Offer the package or the file.

“Unlimited revisions until I’m happy.” One is enough. Happiness with no wall is a project without a date. Write the window. Mean it.

“I do not have examples or an offer yet.” Then they cannot implement. Send a cheaper diagnostic or playbook. Do not invent their business inside a \$600 week.

What this path feeds

This path is the cash pipe. The notes are the product pipe.

What it fills Every job becomes a playbook chapter, a template, or a letter issue. Sam’s 12-post week is a filled calendar someone else might buy as a \$19 file later. Referrals fill the next seats. People who cannot afford \$600 still need a door: send the cheaper file instead of shrinking the package.

What it needs A named package, a deposit link, a spine. It does not need a menu of 12 services. It does not need a team in month one. When

the SOP is real and you are full, raise the price inside \$300–\$1,500 or add a week of wait, before you hire a stranger to talk to your buyers.

Mistakes that eat the week

Work before money, and no walls Working before the deposit. Then you are a friend with a skill, and friends do not get a date on a calendar.

Unlimited revisions. Each round teaches them the first delivery was a suggestion.

Letting them “just hop on a call” that becomes the whole job. Calendly is for kickoff and walkthrough, 15 minutes, after money or after the one-pager. Not for free design-by-conversation.

Raw output and a menu of twelve Delivering unedited AI text. They can smell it. Your name is on it. The model does not refund them.

A menu of 12 services. Custom everything. Starting two packages because you were afraid the first one was too narrow. Narrow is how you keep the date.

Also: disappearing into Slack so the job never ends. Hosting files in a place they cannot export. Discounting seat two because seat one felt awkward. Skipping the referral ask. Skipping the SOP. Those turn a path into a string of tired one-offs.

Tools (keep them boring)

Calendly, Stripe invoice or deposit link, a one-page agreement. That is enough to take money and a date.

Calendly 15-minute kickoff or walkthrough. Not a 60-minute “discovery.” Put the package link in the invite. If they need longer, they need a different product.

Stripe invoice or deposit link Deposit before work.
Balance before or at delivery. Do not take payment in a chat app that will not help you when a charge is disputed.

One-page agreement Repeats the one-pager: in, out, date, price, deposit, revision window, where files live, what they must provide. You are not playing lawyer. You are writing the same sentences in a form they can screenshot.

AI Internal. Draft only. You edit. No shared chat with the client as the deliverable.

Leave retainers, agency CRMs, and a stack of proposal software on the shelf until you have delivered the same package three times.

Checklist

Tick this before you start job two.

Package page - One package, one line: deliverable, days, price
- Who it is for - What is in / what is not - What they must provide - One revision, with a clock - Deposit amount and what it holds - Definition of done (folder they own, walkthrough)

Rails - Calendly 15 minutes - Stripe invoice or deposit link, tested - One-page agreement - Kickoff form

First job - Ten asks to people who already trust you - One discounted first seat only if you need a case - Deposit before chat - AI internally; they never see raw output - Delivery on the date - Referral ask while they are happy - SOP written the same week - Next seat at full price

FAQ

Can I sell two packages if they are related? Not in week one. If you have two, you have none. Deliver the same one three times. Then, maybe, a smaller file for people who fail intake.

What if they want me to post for them too? That is a different dated package, or a no. Do not slide posting into the \$600 week for free. It has no done.

Do I need Calendly if we already chat? Yes, or something with a hard 15-minute wall. Chat has no wall.

How do I handle a bad fit after they pay? Refund the unused work, keep the deposit if you already started and the agreement says so, and stop. Do not work angry to “make it right” with extra scope.

Can I use their job as a case? Ask on the form. Default to fake names. Sam’s tutor said yes to a nameless description. That is enough.

What if I miss the 7-day date? Tell them before the date. Cut scope with their written OK, or finish and own it. Silent delay is how you pay in reputation.

Is \$300 too low? It can be a first-seat price. As a habit it attracts people who want a friend. Move toward \$600–\$1,500 as soon as the SOP is real.

Should I hire someone to draft? Not until you have an SOP and you are full at full price. Hiring on job one is how quality becomes a rumor.

They want unlimited Slack access. No. Folder, form, one revision window, 15-minute walkthrough. Access without a date is hours with extra typing.

When do I turn this into a playbook? When you have notes from two jobs. The package still sells. The file is extra cash from people who will never hire you. Do not pause the package to write the book unless you are full.

